

vode

PRESS KIT 2026/2027

moving. powerful. immediate.



20

around 20 singers, as a full ensemble
and in small formations.

2021

founded as vode e.V. in Bielefeld,
Germany

2026

on stage with the New York Voices at
the Kuppelsaal Hanover



Our ensemble text in three lengths – free to use.

1/3 **SHORT TEXT** 409 characters

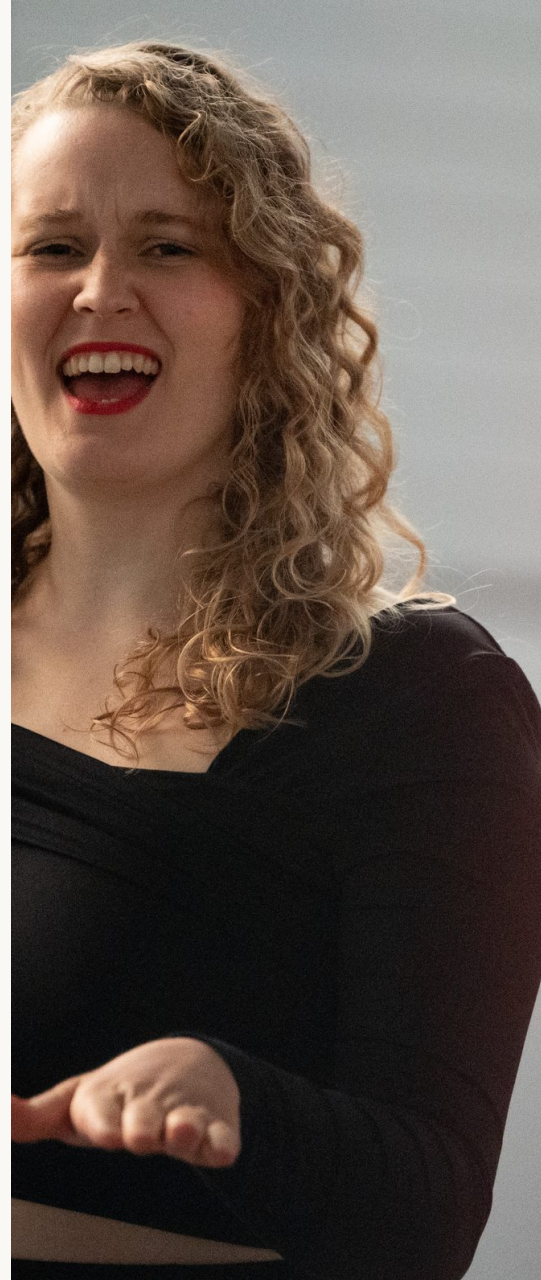
vode is a vocal ensemble from Germany. The approximately 20 singers have shared a close musical and personal bond for many years. In their concerts, they weave their individual voices into a rich and multifaceted ensemble sound while also creating space for smaller vocal formations. Between pop, jazz and contemporary vocal music, vode explores new sonic spaces and creates extraordinary musical experiences.

vode

vode stands for musical passion, distinctive collaborations and immersive concert experiences. Since 2021, the approximately 20 musicians have shared a passion for singing together. Whether performing as a full ensemble or in smaller formations, the singers combine their individual voices into a rich and distinctive ensemble sound. Moving between jazz, pop and contemporary vocal music, vode creates programmes that build musical bridges and make space itself part of the artistic experience.

vode is equally at home on major concert stages and in unconventional concert formats. The ensemble has performed at venues including the Elbphilharmonie Hamburg, the Rudolf-Oetker-Halle in Bielefeld and the Kuppelsaal in Hanover, where vode appeared alongside the New York Voices. Festival appearances have taken the ensemble to Berlin, Freiburg and Cologne.

With formats such as “Concert in the Dark”, vode explores new ways of experiencing concerts, making sound, space and perception integral parts of the musical experience. vode seeks out those moments when the human voice becomes more than music – when sound, space and community come together to create something that exists only in the moment.



ENSEMBLE

around 20 singers, plus smaller formations and solos

GENRE

vocal music between jazz, pop and contemporary

DIRECTORS

Katharina Gärtner and Simon Herten

FOUNDED

2021 as vode e.V., based in Bielefeld, Germany

Long text

vode stands for musical passion, distinctive collaborations and immersive concert experiences. Whether performing as a full ensemble or in smaller formations, each performance reveals the many facets of vode's distinctive sound and allows audiences to experience the voices up close – moving, powerful and immediate. Moving between jazz, pop and contemporary vocal music, vode creates programmes that build musical bridges and make space itself part of the artistic experience.

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vode was founded as a vocal ensemble in 2021, and its members have remained closely connected both musically and personally ever since. vode is a collective of around 20 musicians who bring their diverse creative ideas and individual strengths to the ensemble. These ideas are woven into a cohesive musical whole by Katharina Gärtner and Simon Herten.

With formats such as “Concert in the Dark”, vode is interested in more than sound alone: it is about creating musical experiences. When sight recedes into the background, listening becomes the central experience, bringing voices, sound, space and perception together in an intense and immediate encounter. vode seeks out those moments when the human voice becomes more than music – when sound, space and community come together to create something that exists only in the moment.



Milestones

- 2021** vode e.V. founded in Bielefeld
- 2022** Inaugural concert on 20 August
- 2023** Nacht der Chöre at the Rudolf-Oetker-Halle, Bielefeld
- 2023** Choral event at the Elbphilharmonie, Hamburg
- 2024** TotalChoral festival, Berlin
- 2024** Black Forest Voices festival, Freiburg
- 2025** vode academy: "Chor macht Schule" in Herzfeld
- 2026** voc.cologne festival, Cologne
- 2026** Joint performance with the New York Voices at the Kuppelsaal, Hanover



Directors

Simon Herten

Singer, vocal coach, choir director

Simon Herten studied voice and vocal pedagogy at the Detmold University of Music with teachers including Markus Köhler, Lars Woldt and Ulrike Wahren, and took choral conducting lessons with Anne Kohler. As a singer he performs throughout Germany as a soloist and ensemble member in rock, pop and classical music, both solo and with various ensembles and bands. His other work ranges from individual voice lessons and musical work at schools and universities to directing several pop and jazz choirs.

Katharina Gärtner

Conductor, pianist, music educator

Katharina Gärtner leads the artistic strand of the music education programme at the University of Vechta, where she teaches classical and applied piano and directs the university choir. She trained with Anne Kohler, Fritz ter Wey and Joachim Harder as part of her school music studies at the Detmold University of Music. Courses with the New York Voices, Jesper Holm and Kerry Marsh, among others, gave her further important impulses for directing vocal ensembles. She has led vocal ensembles with different focuses for many years, has taught ensemble direction at several universities and regularly gives training courses and workshops in pop and jazz choir direction.



Photo: Fabian Wohlgemuth

Programmes

Current and past concert programmes. Detailed programme notes are available on request.

01

New programme 2027

Mosaik – Mozaik – Mozayîk

Together with Sümeyye Ergün-Langer (vocals, guitar) and Hayri Arslan (saz), vode brings a musical mosaic to the stage: western Turkish and eastern Anatolian traditions meet Kurdish-Zazaki sounds and vode's jazz and pop. Traditional melodies are carried into new arrangements – a musical trialogue in which each tradition keeps its own colour while becoming part of a shared sound.

03

Advent programme

Silent Light

Silent Light is about seeking and finding a glow in the darkness of the longest night of the year. Inspired by William Blake's poem "To the Evening Star" and the ancient chant "Veni, Veni Emmanuel", vode connects humanity's old questions with contemporary choral sound – in expressive jazz and pop arrangements full of hope, stillness and hidden vitality.

02

Programme 2026

Shifting Tides

In Shifting Tides, vode turns to life's moments of change, the crossroads that keep different paths open. With selected jazz and pop songs, the ensemble tells of inner demons and inner strength, loneliness and encounter, loss and loving memory.

04

Programme

True Colors

In True Colors, vode sings songs by Coldplay, Yebba and OneRepublic alongside classics by Sting, Elton John and the Beatles – about the strong colours and subtle shades of life. Alongside full-ensemble pieces, characterful solos and delicate arrangements for smaller formations, with and without instruments, can be heard.



Still from "Chor macht Schule" · film: Roman Schauerte

For us, singing is more than art – it is an attitude.

Making music in a group means listening to yourself and giving your own voice space, but equally paying attention to the other voices. That is what ultimately leads to harmony – on stage as in life.

"The idea is that we as a choir sit in on the rehearsal, right among the participants, so that everything mixes straight away and people come together as a group."

Tobias Hägele, singer with vode

At vode, around 20 musicians bring together very different skills: vocal coaching, school teaching, sound engineering, arranging and composition. This diversity has shaped a distinctive rehearsal culture in which everyone helps shape the result. We pass on this principle – that every single voice matters – in workshops, coaching sessions and choral projects, such as "Chor macht Schule" in 2025 with young people from school choirs in the region.

"For me, one of the great rewards of working with young people is seeing that something is happening behind their eyes."

Katharina Gärtner, director of vode

More about vode academy www.vode-ensemble.de/academy



PHOTOS, LOGOS & TEXTS

Print-resolution press photos, our logo for light and dark backgrounds and all texts ready to copy are on our press page:

vode-ensemble.de/presse

VIDEOS

Bli-Blip | vode & New York Voices

youtu.be/UWVHe51-kG8

vode – Back in the High Life Again

youtu.be/GxzoyGThUiQ

Chor macht Schule – der Film (vode academy)

youtu.be/aCKdSreAPIU

Contact & booking

For booking enquiries, interviews and further material, contact Maria Anna Waloschek at

mail@vode-ensemble.de

www.vode-ensemble.de Instagram [@vode.ensemble](https://www.instagram.com/vode.ensemble)

TECHNICAL

An updated technical rider is in preparation. We are happy to agree technical details for each event.

vode e.V. · Bielefeld

Photos unless otherwise credited: Dominik Moos